

Ediglobe Minor Project- Cyber Security

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Topic : Phishing Awareness Campaign

Phishing Awareness Campaign - Design and execute a mock phishing campaign within the organization to raise awareness among employees about phishing attacks and their identification.

What is phishing?

Phishing is a common scam that attempts to lure you into giving up your username, password, or other sensitive information by masquerading as someone you know and trust. This can be done by phone, but is typically done in email. The email may appear to come from ECSU or another company you do business with, and it often asks you to click a link, open an attachment, or reply with your account or personal information.



It is a common method of online identity theft and cyber attacks. Attackers often use email, SMS, and various social media platforms to carry sophisticated attacks. They send messages that contain malicious content, often in the form of URLs.

These messages often mimic banks, credit card companies, or other businesses like Amazon and eBay, making them look authentic and convincing victims to reveal their personal information.

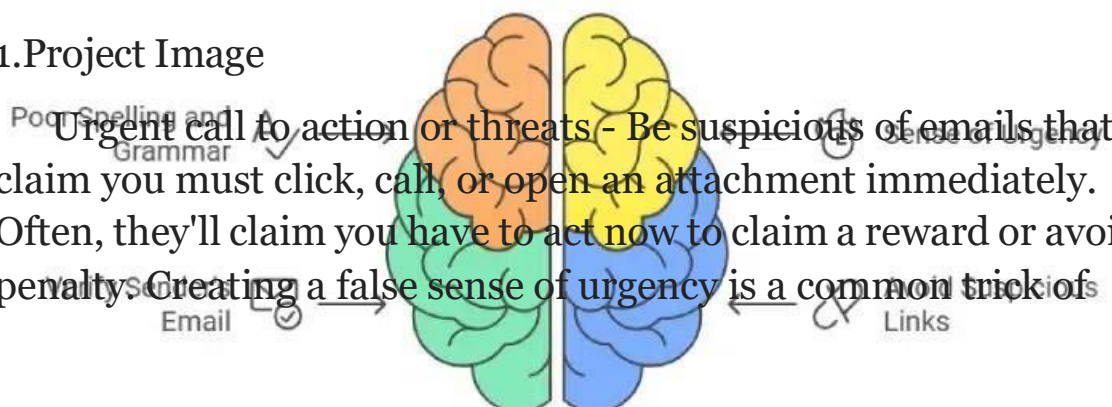
Phishing is a type of cyber attack that leverages social engineering techniques. It manipulates you into giving away private information by impersonating a trusted person or company like a bank or colleague. Phishing attacks can happen via email, phone calls, texts and social media. They are designed to bait you into clicking on a malicious link or opening a malicious file. A more sophisticated type of phishing attack is known as spear fishing. This attack is targeted towards a specific person, making it more believable and effective.

phishing emails;

Phishing Email Identification Guide

1. Project Image

Urgent call to action or threats - Be suspicious of emails that claim you must click, call, or open an attachment immediately. Often, they'll claim you have to act now to claim a reward or avoid a penalty. Creating a false sense of urgency is a common trick of



1. Check the Email Address

Phishers often hide their real email addresses to look like they're from reputable sources. Pay attention to slight variations in the sender's email address.

Legitimate emails: From well-known domains

like `@bank.com` or `@amazon.com`.

Phishing attempt: Look for unusual domain names like `@service-support.com` or `@amazonsupport.net`.

The domain name might be similar to a legitimate domain but with an extra character or misspelled.

Example:

- **Phishing:** `support@amaz0n-security.com` (Note the "0" instead of the letter "o").
- **Legitimate:** `support@amazon.com`

2. Sense of Urgency or Threat

Phishing emails often create a sense of urgency or fear to prompt quick action. For example, they might threaten that your account will be locked unless you take action immediately, or you risk losing a reward.

- **Legitimate emails:** Legitimate companies usually don't pressure you to act right away.
- **Phishing attempt:** Emails that demand immediate action to avoid penalties or losses are highly suspicious.

Example:

- **Phishing:** *“Your account has been compromised. Click here immediately to avoid your account being locked.”*
- **Legitimate:** *“We’ve detected some unusual activity. Please review your account when convenient.”*

3. Suspicious or Generic Greeting

Phishing emails often use a generic greeting such as “Dear Customer” or “Dear User” because the attacker does not know your actual Name or Gender.

- **Legitimate emails:** Most legitimate companies address you by your name (e.g., “Dear John Doe”).
- **Phishing attempt:** Generic greetings or misspellings in the salutation are red flags.

Example:

- **Phishing:** *“Dear Customer, your account has been compromised.”*
- **Legitimate:** *“Dear John Doe, we’ve noticed unusual activity on your account.”*

4. Suspicious Links or Attachments

Phishing emails often include suspicious links or attachments designed to install malware on your device or steal your information. Hover over any link to check its destination URL.

- **Legitimate emails:** Links in legitimate emails lead to official websites (e.g., <https://www.amazon.com>).
- **Phishing attempt:** Hovering over a link might show a different URL than expected, such as <http://www.malicioussite.com>.

Example:

- **Phishing:** A link that looks like www.yourbank-secure.com, but actually redirects to www.maliciousbank.com.
- **Legitimate:** A direct link to the official website (e.g., www.yourbank.com).

5. Grammar and Spelling Mistakes

Many phishing emails contain noticeable spelling or grammatical errors. These can often be overlooked, but paying attention to these small mistakes can help you recognize a phishing email.

- **Legitimate emails:** Professional emails from reputable companies are proofread and free of errors.
- **Phishing attempt:** Phishing emails may have awkward phrasing, incorrect spelling, or missing punctuation.

Example:

- **Phishing:** “Your account is suspicious, click here to secure your profile.”

- **Legitimate:** *“Your account has been flagged for suspicious activity. Please review your account details.”*

6. Unsolicited Requests for Personal Information

Phishing emails often ask you to provide sensitive information, such as login credentials, credit card details, or personal information.

- **Legitimate emails:** No reputable company will ask you to provide sensitive information via email.
- **Phishing attempt:** Emails requesting you to confirm your login information, PIN, or Social Security number.

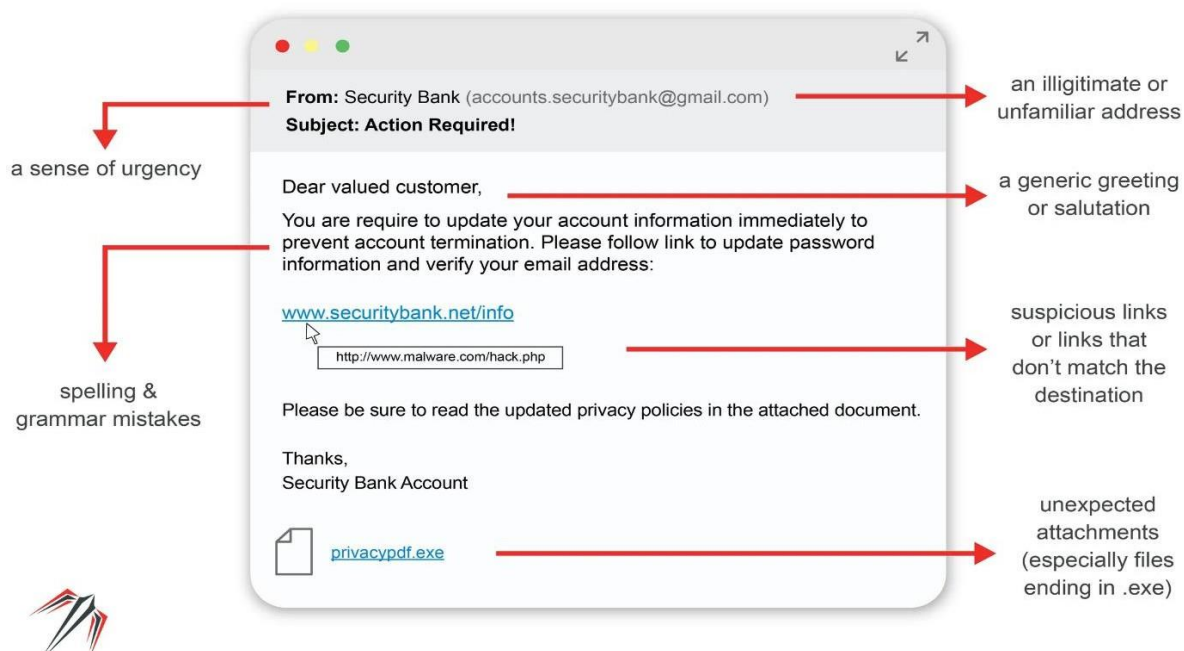
Example:

- **Phishing:** *“We need to confirm your identity. Please provide your username and password to avoid account suspension.”*
- **Legitimate:** *“We noticed suspicious activity on your account. Please review your recent transactions.”*

Example:1

It highlights various warning signs using an example email from "Security Bank." Some key red flags include: a sense of urgency, spelling and grammar mistakes, an illegitimate or unfamiliar email address, a generic greeting, suspicious links, and unexpected attachments. Each of these signs is pointed out with arrows and labels, making it easier for viewers to identify potential phishing attempts and protect themselves from cyber threats.

WATCH OUT FOR...



Check E-mail in Different Point of View Before Open:

Check the Sender's Email Address:

Verify that the email is from a legitimate source. Phishing emails often use addresses that look similar to trusted organizations but have slight variations.

Look for Generic Greetings:

Be cautious of emails that start with generic greetings like "Dear Customer" instead of using your name.

Verify Links:

Hover over any links without clicking to see if the URL matches the official website. Phishing emails often contain links to fraudulent websites.

Beware of Urgent Language:

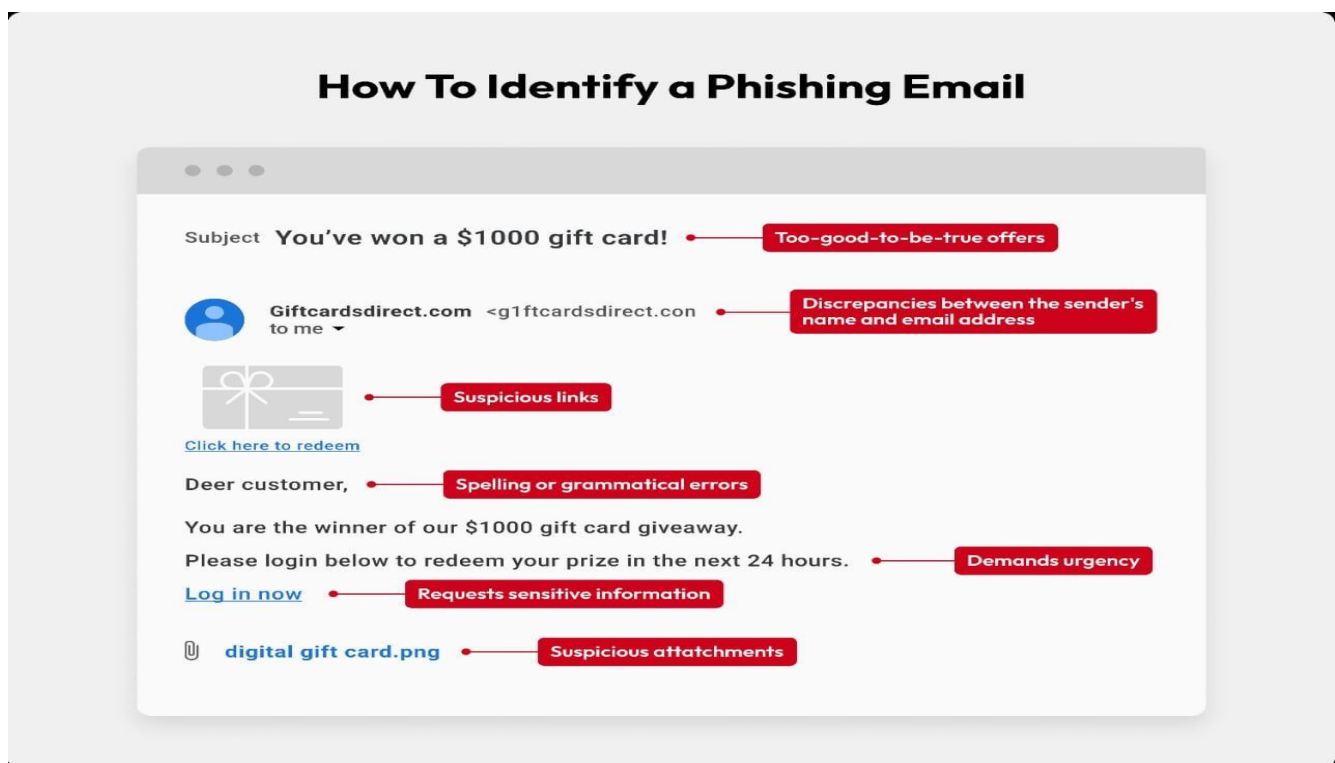
Phishing emails often create a sense of urgency, prompting you to act quickly without thinking. Examples include "Your account will be locked!" or "Immediate action required!"

Check for Spelling and Grammar Errors:

Legitimate companies usually proofread their emails before sending them out. Multiple spelling and grammar mistakes can be a red flag.

Example:2

The infographic titled "How To Identify a Phishing Email" uses a sample email to highlight various red flags of phishing attempts. Key signs include offers that seem too good to be true, discrepancies between the sender's name and email address, suspicious links, spelling or grammatical errors, demands for urgency, requests for sensitive information, and suspicious attachments. This visual guide is designed to educate users on how to recognize and avoid falling victim to phishing scams.



Tips to Prevent Phishing Attacks

While being able to spot phishing messages is critical, there are several proactive steps you can take to prevent these attacks from succeeding:

1. Use Email Filters

Most email providers offer spam filters that help flag suspicious emails before they even reach your inbox. Make sure your filters are set up and updated regularly.

2. Educate Employees

For businesses, one of the best defences against phishing is employee training. Ensure your staff knows how to recognize phishing attempts and what to do if they receive one.

3. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

MFA provides an additional layer of security, making it much harder for attackers to access your accounts even if they've stolen your password.

4. Keep Software Updated

Regularly updating your operating systems, browsers, and security software helps protect against vulnerabilities that attackers can exploit.

5. Use a Password Manager

A password manager generates and stores strong, unique passwords for each of your accounts, making it difficult for cybercriminals to use compromised passwords from phishing attacks.

Phishing Campaigns:

You can typically identify phishing campaigns simply by analysing the content of the email:

- If an email came unprompted and is requesting sensitive data, it is likely a phishing scam. A legitimate organization will never ask for any personal information, including passwords, via email.
- If an email is creating a sense of urgency or is trying to invoke fear for you to take action, such as changing your password now, it is likely a phishing scam.
- If an email contains hyperlinks that do not match the web addresses for the organization that it came from, it is likely a phishing scam.

Using just a few best practices, you can be sure to not fall victim to a phishing campaign:

- Always review the sender of an email. For example, if you received an email claiming to be the UNG Information

Technology department, but the sender is from a Google Mail account, this would be phishing scam.

- Always hover your mouse cursor over hyperlinks in email messages prior to clicking them. By hovering your mouse over a link, the real web address will be displayed which can be used to confirm if the link is legitimate or not. For example, if there is a hyperlink claiming to be an email logon for UNG, but upon hovering over it displays an unknown website address, this would be a phishing scam.
- Prior to logging in on a website, confirm that the address in the address bar is correct, and ensure that the connection is secure. If you are attempting to log in to a UNG service, but the website address does not match UNG, this is not a legitimate service. To confirm that your connection is secure, look for a green lock near the address bar, and confirm that the website address begins with https:// and not http:// .
- If a phishing email is received, contact the Information Security department using the methods listed below.

Reporting Phishing Attempts

If you suspect that an email you received is a phishing campaign, you may forward it to the Information Security department at spam@ung.edu for analysis and advice for any further action on your part. In order to ensure that the Information Security department receives the full details from the email message, please forward the email as an attachment by using the following procedures:

Outlook Desktop Client

Windows

1. Select the phishing email in Outlook.
2. On your keyboard, press CTRL+ALT+F . This will create a new email message with the phishing email automatically attached.
3. Add any pertinent details to the body of your new email message.
4. Send this email to support team.

Macintosh

1. Right click the phishing email in Outlook, navigate to “Forward Special” and select “As Attachment.”
2. Add any pertinent details to the body of your new email message.
3. Send this email to support team.

How do we stop getting phished?

Verify the sender by checking their email address — WHO sender addresses use the person@who.int pattern. NOT Gmail, etc.

Check the link, before you click — make sure the links start with https:// and not http://

Be careful when providing personal information — never provide your credentials to third parties, not even the WHO.

Do not rush or panic react — scammers use this in order to pressure you into clicking links or opening attachments.

If you gave sensitive information, don't panic — reset your credentials on sites you've used them. Change your passwords and contact your bank immediately.

Real World Scenario

A phishing scenario targeting an organization typically involves cybercriminals attempting to steal sensitive information by impersonating a trusted entity

The screenshot shows a Gmail interface with a search bar at the top and a list of emails in the inbox. The email titled "Gartner BI Magic Quadrant See Where BI is Going in 2013" is highlighted. The sender is "Gartner BI Magic Quadrant" and the subject is "Gartner BI Magic Quadrant See Where BI is Going in 2013 - QlikView.com/Magic_Quadrant - Don't Make A Move Without It!". The email body contains a link to "QlikView.com/Magic_Quadrant" and a warning not to make a move without it. The email is marked as "Spam" and "Phishing".

Google

Rapportive - Arik Hanson

Gmail

1-50 of 25,262

COMPOSE

Inbox (12,992)

Important
Sent Mail
Drafts (111)

Circles

- Friends (11)
- Family
- Acquaintanc...
- Following
- BlogWorld

Search people...

- Aaron Landry
- Adam Ostrow
- Amy Mengel
- Chuck Hemann
- David Teicher
- Grant Spanier
- Jason DeBoer...
- Jesse Stremcha
- Kendall Bird
- Tara Cegla

Gartner BI Magic Quadrant See Where BI is Going in 2013 - QlikView.com/Magic_Quadrant - Don't Make A Move Without It! Why this ad?

Sender	Subject	Time
Google Alerts	Google Alert - open streets minnesota - News 1 new result for open streets minnesota Open Streets Buffalo KSTP.co	3:50 pm
Spotify	This Week's New Music - See what's new on Spotify View in your browser Spotify They came, they saw, they rocked!	3:37 pm
FAVES + CO.	[New post] Reddit promotes "Restore Your Rights Rally" on July 4th - Sarah posted: "Reddit is the one of the main	3:33 pm
Rick Kupchella	The Afternoon News - To view this email as a web page, go here. Email not displaying correctly? View it in your brows	3:31 pm
SuddenBlitz Alert	57% OFF! \$16 for a 8 pack of Mach 3 Turbo Refill Blades with Free shipping a (\$36.99 Va... - Please add campaigns	2:40 pm
Laura Kaslow via LinkedIn	RE: Opportunity with Allina? - Laura Kaslow Communications expert with a focus in public relations Hi Arik, Thanks fo	2:25 pm
Julie, me (2)	talk today? - Sure—what's your number again? Or, you can call me at 612.875.2979. Also: Email me at arik@	2:24 pm
PR Daily Extra	Writing tips for the Web - PR Daily News Feed 13 writing tips for the Web Writing & Editing 13 writing tips for the Web	1:56 pm
Social Media Insider Sum.	Where new business begins and genuine friendships are born (Social Media Insider Summit... - Social Media Insid	1:51 pm
FAVES + CO.	[New post] Don't let technology take the place of face-to-face interactions in your fam... - Sarah posted: "It was reci	1:42 pm
Sarah Tobin (5)	Join my network on LinkedIn - LinkedIn Logo Arik, Sarah Tobin wants to connect with you on LinkedIn. 10 shared con	1:28 pm
AirTran Airways Net Esca.	Get Your Beach On - Mexico & the Caribbean on sale! - Deals on flights for travel 8/20 - 12/18/13, car rentals, hotels,	1:11 pm
iTunes Store	Your receipt No.126056066605 - Billed To: arik.hanson@gmail.com Arik Hanson 5336 11th Ave S Minneapolis, MN 5	1:10 pm
FAVES + CO.	[New post] Apply to speak at TED@NYC talent search - Sarah posted: "In 2014 TED will celebrate their 30th anniver	1:00 pm
PR Daily	5 reasons reporters hate your pitches (and how to solve them) - They're too long! The quotes are not "human." They ac	12:34 pm
Larsmont Cottages	E-Break From Lake Superior - Reserve Your Stay A friend told me about a cow moose with twin calves that have beer	11:59 am
Newsle	News about Keith Trivitt, John Bernier, Chris Heuer, Cory Treffiletti, Dan Jasper... - Know your network. Your Linke	11:58 am
HARO	[HARO] Tuesday Afternoon Queries "Facebook Cheat Sheet" Edition - Content marketing requires creativity. But yo	11:43 am
Convince and Convert	Winning the Marketing Battle Between Help and Hype - One Thing :: The News You Need and Nothing Else View this (	11:43 am
Foursquare	Joram Manka wants to be your friend on Foursquare! - Hi Arik, Just a heads-up — Joram Manka wants to be your fri	11:34 am

Sample mail Template

Template 1: Fake Security Alert

Subject: Urgent: Your Account Has Been Locked!

Email Body:

Dear [Employee Name],

We have detected unusual login attempts on your account from an unknown location. As a security measure, your account has been temporarily locked.

To restore access, please verify your identity immediately by clicking the link below:

[Verify Your Account](#)

If you do not verify within 24 hours, your account may be permanently disabled.

Regards,

IT Security Team

Analysis Result:

5. Results & Analysis

- Total number of emails sent:  e.g., 50
- Total emails opened:  e.g., 40
- Total clicks on phishing link:  e.g., 30
- Total credential submissions:  e.g., 10
- Total reported as phishing:  e.g., 5

5.1 Data Representation

(Use graphs or charts to show results visually.)

Thank you